RESEARCH MEMORANDUM

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HOW THE NUMBER 137 IN ANCIENT TRADITION ARE ALSO BIG CLUES

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SUMMARY

- **In physics, 137 sets how strongly light and matter act on each other.** The fine-structure constant equals 1 divided by 137.036: a pure number with no units, whose value no theory derives, at least not in physics. [1; 2]
- **Could the Rendlesham Forest craft have been trying to lead us to hidden clues seeded in the past?**
- **In Kabbalah, 137 is the tradition's own number.** Its name, קבלה, *kabbalah*, "receiving", sums to 137, and receiving is its central question: how a vessel can hold the divine light. The same sum spells ממונא, *memuna*, "the appointed one", the Book of Raziel's title for the angel Raziel. [3-5]
- **In Islam, every prayer is aimed at 137.** The qibla, the direction a Muslim must face for any prayer to be valid, is written with the four letters of *kabbalah* and sums to 137. It faces the House of the One the Quran calls "the Light of the heavens and the earth" (24:35): **Islam's direction of prayer is receiving the light.** Abraham and Ishmael built that House, praying "Our Lord! Accept [this] from us", with *accept* from the same root. [6-9]

Josh note:

Intelligent Design?

In physics, 137 appears to be an arbitrarily chosen factor. Not so in antiquity. The indwelling divine feminine that Kabbalah calls the Shekhinah, and that the Canaanites and early Israelites called Asherah, wife of God and Lady of the Sea [10], chose this number on purpose. Physics measures her number as the strength with which light meets matter. The clue to this is Kabbalah writes the same number as "kabbalah", or "receiving": in its own terms, light, the divine emanation, taken into a vessel, the form that holds it. **137 is the very Secret of Power, the "Razi - El" (their secret angel) of Creation. But what could that secret of power mean?**

I. IN KABBALAH

- **Every Hebrew letter is also a number, and a word's value is the sum of its letters.** Gershom Scholem, founder of the modern academic study of Kabbalah, first noted the sum of *kabbalah* in the 1950s. [11; 12] These Hebrew words sum to 137, letter by letter: [3; 13-15]

Word	Letters	Meaning and place
קבלה, *kabbalah*	100+2+30+5	**"Receiving"**; five times in the Book of Raziel
ממונא, *memuna*	40+40+6+50+1	"The holy appointed one, the angel Raziel", in the Book of Raziel, which Raziel gave to Adam
אופן, *ofan*	1+6+80+50	**"Wheel"**: the wheels of Ezekiel's vision, their rims full of eyes (Ezekiel 1:15-18); in Maimonides, the second of the ten orders of angels
יופיאל, *Yofiel*	10+6+80+10+1+30	In the Zohar, a chief angel over 53 legions that oversee the **Sabbath Torah readings**

- **The Mishnah's chain of tradition begins with receiving**: "Moses received the Torah at Sinai and transmitted it to Joshua" (Avot 1:1), where *received* is *kibbel*, the root of *kabbalah*. [16]
- **In Isaac Luria's account of creation (16th century), God's light was too intense for the ten vessels made for it: the seven lower vessels broke and the three upper vessels held.** Read digit by digit, 1-3-7 gives the same account: one light, three vessels that held it, seven vessels that broke. Yehuda Ashlag's 20th-century system focused on changing the "desire to receive" into the "desire to give". [4; 5]
- **137 is the 33rd prime number, and 33 is the Zohar's day.** 33 in Hebrew letters is ל״ג, *lag*: Lag BaOmer, the 33rd day of the Omer count, is kept as the anniversary of the death of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai, to whom tradition ascribes the Zohar, the foundational work of Kabbalah. **The same two letters, reversed, spell** גל, ***gal*, "uncover"**: "uncover my eyes, that I may behold wondrous things out of your Torah" (Psalm 119:18). [13; 17; 18]
- **Also, Ishmael, Levi and Amram lived exactly 137 years**: Abraham's first son (Genesis 25:17), the ancestor of the priestly tribe and great-grandfather of Moses (Exodus 6:16), and the father of Moses, Aaron and Miriam (Exodus 6:20). [13]

II. IN ISLAM

- **The root of *kabbalah*, ק-ב-ל, means both "receive" and "face"**: the Tabernacle's curtain loops are *lula'ot makbilot*, "loops that face one another" (Exodus 26:5). **In Arabic the same root gives *qibla*, "the direction faced"**: "turn your face towards the Sacred Mosque [in Mecca]--wherever you are, turn your faces towards it" (Quran 2:144). [6; 7; 13]

- **Arabic letters carry the same number values as the matching Hebrew letters**: *qibla*, spelled with a final ه in Persian, is ق 100, ب 2, ل 30 and ه 5. [8; 9]

III. THE RENDLESHAM FOREST INCIDENT

- **On two nights in late December 1980, US Air Force personnel from RAF Woodbridge and RAF Bentwaters, in Suffolk, England, encountered lights and a craft in Rendlesham Forest.** Patrolmen found "a strange glowing object in the forest", metallic and triangular, that "illuminated the entire forest with a white light". Sergeant Jim Penniston put his hand on the symbols etched on its side, and "everything became a brilliant bright white". Three depressions were found where it had stood, with radiation readings highest inside them. On the second night, deputy base commander Lieutenant Colonel Charles Halt watched a red sun-like light break into five white objects, then star-like lights, the brightest of which beamed a stream of light down from time to time. The day after his encounter, Penniston saw ones and zeros in his mind and wrote them down: 16 pages of binary code, which he revealed in 2010 and which decode into English words and map coordinates. [19-22]
- **The code points to 137.** One of its seven coordinates, 29.977836 N 31.131649 E, is the Great Pyramid at Giza. Penniston's co-author Gary Osborn found that the Giza latitude dividing the distance between the centres of the first and third pyramids in the golden ratio, 29.9766248 degrees north, runs 320 royal cubits from the Great Pyramid's south base and 70 royal cubits from the second pyramid's north base. **Multiplied by 320/70, that latitude gives 137.035999: the fine-structure constant.** [21; 23]
- **Penniston received the message; he did not read it.** He touched the symbols, white light filled everything, and the next day the code came to him and he wrote it down. **That is *kabbalah*, "receiving", in its first sense: a teaching received from above and passed on.** [21]
- **The code is written the way Hebrew is: letters that are numbers.** Each group of eight ones and zeros is a number, and each number stands for a letter. The symbols he touched arrived as numbers and read as words: letters and numbers, which the *Sefer Yetzirah*, the Kabbalah's Book of Creation, names as the means of creation. [22; 24]
- **The code says "EYES OF YOUR EYES"; the 137 word *ofan* is the wheel "full of eyes" in Ezekiel's vision of a shining craft** (Ezekiel 1:4, 1:18). [13; 22]
- **The code gives its purpose as humanity's advancement**: "EXPLORATION OF HUMANITY", "CONTINUOUS FOR PLANETARY ADVAN[CEMENT]". In Luria's account, the vessels broke because they were not yet mature enough to contain the light. **Advancement, in these terms, is a vessel made able to receive the light.** [4; 22]
- **The coordinates lead mostly to ancient sacred sites**: Giza, the Nazca lines in Peru, Caracol in Belize, Tai Shan in China, and the Portara, the gate of Apollo's temple on Naxos. The others are Sedona, in Arizona, and Hy-Brasil, the legendary island west of Ireland that the code gives as its "ORIGIN".

The message sends its reader to ancient tradition, where 137 is found. [21; 22]

Therefore a reasonable translation of the significance of 137 could mean:
"Receiving the Light is the Secret of Power."

SOURCES

[1] NIST. CODATA 2022 recommended values: inverse fine-structure constant, 137.035 999 177(21).

[2] Arthur I. Miller. *137: Jung, Pauli, and the Pursuit of a Scientific Obsession*. W. W. Norton, 2009.

[3] *Sefer Raziel HaMalakh*, 1881 printing.

[4] "Shattered Vessels: Introduction to the Ari's Concept of Shevirat haKeilim". Chabad.org.

[5] "Yehuda Ashlag". *Wikipedia*.

[6] The Quran 2:127, 2:144 and 24:35, translated by Mustafa Khattab, *The Clear Quran*.

[7] "Qibla". *Wikipedia*.

[8] "Abjad numerals". *Wikipedia*.

[9] "qibla", Persian entry. *Wiktionary*.

[10] "Asherah": consort of El at Ugarit, "Lady Athirat of the Sea". *Wikipedia*.

[11] Philip R. Brown. "Mysticism and the Fine Structure Constant". *Journal of Scientific Exploration* 34, no. 3 (2020).

[12] "Gershom Scholem". *Wikipedia*.

[13] Hebrew Bible: Genesis 25:17; Exodus 6:16, 6:20, 26:5; Psalm 119:18; Ezekiel 1:4, 1:15-18.

[14] Maimonides. *Mishneh Torah*, Foundations of the Torah 2:7: the ten orders of angels, the Ofanim second.

[15] "Jophiel": Yofiel in the Zohar. *Wikipedia*.

[16] Mishnah: Avot 1:1.

[17] "Lag BaOmer". *Wikipedia*.

[18] "Zohar". *Wikipedia*.

[19] "Rendlesham Forest incident". *Wikipedia*.

[20] Charles I. Halt. "Unexplained Lights", memorandum to the UK Ministry of Defence, 13 January 1981.

[21] Gary Osborn. "How the Rendlesham Forest Incident binary code message was received, revealed and decoded". 2022.

[22] "Origin Year 8100": the decoded binary message. *Stranger Dimensions*.

[23] Gary Osborn. "How the Rendlesham Binary Code Message Authenticates Itself". 2023.

[24] "Sefer Yetzirah". *Wikipedia*.